Nathan Francis Ripaldi
Procurement Operations & Supply Chain Executive | Aerospace, Defense & National Laboratories
Nathan.F.Ripaldi@gmail.com | 415/265-4513 | Santa Clarita, CA

EXPERIENCE

SLAC National Accelerator Laboratory, operated by Stanford University **Mar. 2026 – Present**
Senior Manager, Procurement Operations / Supply Chain Management *Menlo Park, CA*

- Lead procurement operations for a Department of Energy national laboratory operated by Stanford University, directing 4 managers and approximately 35 professionals across commodities, complex services, construction, high-value scientific equipment, small business, training, and compliance
- Set enterprise priorities and the operating model for teams executing technically complex acquisitions supporting world-class research, capital infrastructure, and laboratory operations; align workload, decision rights, risk escalation, and stakeholder engagement
- Modernize acquisition governance and audit readiness through tiered review controls, FAR/DEAR-aligned procedures, proposal-adequacy and supplier-responsibility standards, defensible source-selection models, and AI-enabled price/cost and risk analytics
- Drive portfolio performance through KPI management, surge and workload forecasting, cross-functional issue resolution, and a structured closeout strategy for approximately 370 services files, targeting a 50% backlog reduction by fiscal year-end
- Lead workforce transformation through generalist cross-training, six-month rotations, manager and individual-contributor development plans, peer-review capability, succession planning, and coaching that strengthens judgment across the acquisition lifecycle
- Direct small-business strategy, supplier-risk and resilience initiatives, tariff and HTS governance, and coordination with Property, ES&H, Engineering, and program customers to protect mission continuity and strengthen compliant competition

Raytheon Intelligence & Space **Aug. 2025 – Mar. 2026**
Senior Manager, Commodity Management & Strategic Sourcing *Goleta, CA*

- Directed strategic sourcing and procurement operations for Electronic Warfare Systems programs, managing annual spend across RF components, PCBs, power systems, and mission-critical electronic assemblies
- Led a team of sourcing managers and analysts through supplier negotiations, cost analysis, and contract execution in alignment with FAR/DFARS/ITAR and corporate procurement standards
- Developed commodity strategies including long-term agreements (LTAs), dual-sourcing, and obsolescence risk management to mitigate DMSMS challenges and sustain EWS lifecycle support
- Served as key customer interface with the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA), Defense Contract Audit Agency (DCAA), and government SPO/PMO, providing transparent procurement documentation and audits

Lockheed Martin Aeronautics Company (Skunk Works) **Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2025**
Category Management, Manager *Palmdale, CA*

- Led a 15-person team supporting the Air Launched Rapid Response Weapon Program (ARRW / AGM-183A), “LBFD” or Low Boom Flight Demonstrator, and Special Access Programs
- Led 6 Contractor Purchasing System Reviews (CPSRs) since 2013, directing audit preparation, procurement file reviews, and cross-functional coordination to demonstrate purchasing system compliance with FAR Part 44
- Served as proposal lead and cost-volume reviewer; executed color-team and gate reviews to refine win themes supporting Capture Review (CR), Independent Non-Advocate Reviews (INAR), and Program Performance Reviews
- Oversaw subcontract lifecycle from proposal/capture through execution, ensuring compliance with the Lockheed Martin Acquisition Policy and Procedure (LMAP) and Department of Defense (DoD) regulations
- Taught subcontracts personnel price/cost analysis and all contract types, and performed pre-solicitation and pre-award procurement compliance reviews
- Developed and implemented procurement objectives, Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), strategies, and initiatives aligned with Lockheed Martin's Long-Range Plan (LRP) to ensure supply-chain resiliency

Lockheed Martin Aeronautics Company (Skunk Works) **May 2019 – Jun. 2022**
Subcontracts Management, Associate Manager *Palmdale, CA*

- Directed a 26-person subcontract management team across classified programs and LBFD
- Functioned as proposal manager for LBFD and other special-action programs; coordinated pricing, technical, and subcontract narratives
- Managed Special Access Programs (SAP) with expected subcontract value (s) exceeding $1B
- Briefed senior leaders, rebuilt challenging subcontractor relationships, and improved operating discipline across supplier performance, material tracking, metrics, and risk management

Lockheed Martin Aeronautics Company (Skunk Works) **Jul. 2017 – May 2019**
Subcontracts Management, Staff *Palmdale, CA*

- Served as team lead on Tactical Boost Glide (TBG) and ARRW hypersonic programs, driving subcontract execution in high-visibility environments
- Mentored and developed organizational talent, strengthening team capability through formal coaching
- Applied subject-matter expertise across CPIF, CPFF, CPAF, FFP, LOE, and T&M under FAR/DFARS and Other Transaction Authority (OTA) — cost-reimbursable contracting, compliance reviews, cost/price analysis, technical evaluations, and time-phasing methodologies driving subcontracts management performance

Lockheed Martin Aeronautics Company **Sep. 2015 – Jul. 2017**
Control Account Manager *Fort Worth, TX*

- Single point of contact for a $500M control account's scope, schedule, and technical performance; led procurement decisions affecting the control account
- Prepared Control Account Variance Analysis reports with impact statements and corrective-action narratives; provided forecast dates for remaining activities
- Proactively managed subcontractor effort — approving hours, material, and other direct costs, and identifying technical, schedule, and cost risk

Lockheed Martin Aeronautics Company **Jan. 2013 – Sep. 2015**
Subcontracts Management, Senior *Fort Worth, TX*

- Managed a $500M subcontracting portfolio for F-35 Low-Rate Initial Production (LRIP) lots 6–8, ensuring on-time delivery of hardware, data, and contract deliverables
- Administered and executed CPIF, CPFF, and FFP contract types with Northrop Grumman Mission Systems (NGMS) RADAR
- Led Panoramic Cockpit Display System procurements, delivering $50M+ in competitive and international follow-on orders (Kongsberg, Norway)

Lockheed Martin Space **Aug. 2009 – Dec. 2012**
Subcontracts Administrator *Sunnyvale, CA*

- Managed suppliers on the Fleet Ballistic Missile (FBM) D5 Life Extension and Test Missile Kit programs; developed and delivered Government Follow-On Production Orders exceeding $10M
- Prepared competitive and non-competitive RFPs, supported proposal activity, negotiated NDAs, and maintained audit ready procurement files for FAR/DFARS compliance, and internal-policy compliance

ADDITIONAL

- Golden Gate University, M.S., Taxation (2007); University of Wisconsin-Madison, B.S., Legal Studies (2006)
- Active Top Secret (TS) clearance; Member, National Contract Management Association (NCMA)
- Control Account Manager (CAM), and Lean Six Sigma Green Belt Certifications
- SAP ERP Subject Matter Expert; Excel, PowerPoint, Word, and Procure-to-Pay systems (SAP / PeopleSoft / Oracle)
- **Applied AI (Claude/Anthropic):** Modernized source-selection instruments; converted FAR/DEAR/DFARS policy into forms, playbooks, and training; built scheduled workflows for inbox triage and executive reporting
- **Responsible AI:** Human-in-the-loop review of every output against source documents and regulatory authority; clean-room sourcing, no proprietary content in AI tools, and sandboxed testing
- Developed Subcontract SOW Checker, EVM database, contract architecture, and Parametric Database (planned for Sandia National Laboratories use) supporting acquisition quality and cost analysis